

Kestrel Home Appliances - Operations Policy v4.1

Internal. Owner: D2C Operations.

§1 Scope

This policy covers order fulfilment, returns, service visits and warranty operations for Kestrel Home D2C and partner-outlet sales.

§4 Costs used for decisions

A returned order costs Kestrel **Rs 1,150** on average (reverse pickup, QC inspection, repacking, write-down), on top of the refund itself.

A pre-dispatch confirmation call costs **Rs 45** (outsourced calling, per completed call).

Blended cost of a service contact: Rs 260. Technician visit: Rs 540.

§6 Kestrel Shield

Shield members get free returns within 30 days, free annual service and 24-month cover. Shield members account for roughly a fifth of orders and the highest lifetime value of any segment.

§7 Returns process

A return starts when the customer raises it (app, call centre or partner outlet). Once the return is approved, the logistics system books a reverse pickup and writes *pickup_scheduled_at*; the service system records a REVERSE_PICKUP event against the order. Pickups are occasionally booked and then cancelled.

Holding orders. An order held at dispatch for more than 24 hours is cancelled by the customer about **12%** of the time.

Pre-dispatch call pilot. A confirmation call before dispatch prevented about **35%** of the returns that would otherwise have happened on called orders (wrong model, wrong address, buyer's remorse).

§9 Systems and timestamps

Until 30 Sep 2025 service and order operations ran on the legacy Zoho Desk instance. From 1 Oct 2025 everything runs on the Kestrel CRM. Legacy records were migrated in bulk; the *source* column says which system a row came from.

All timestamps in exports are Indian Standard Time as displayed in the CRM, **except** resolution events imported from the legacy Zoho event log, which were stored in UTC and were not converted during migration.

§10 Data handling

Customer and operational data may be shared with approved vendors for analysis. It must not be published, uploaded to public repositories or shared beyond the engagement team.